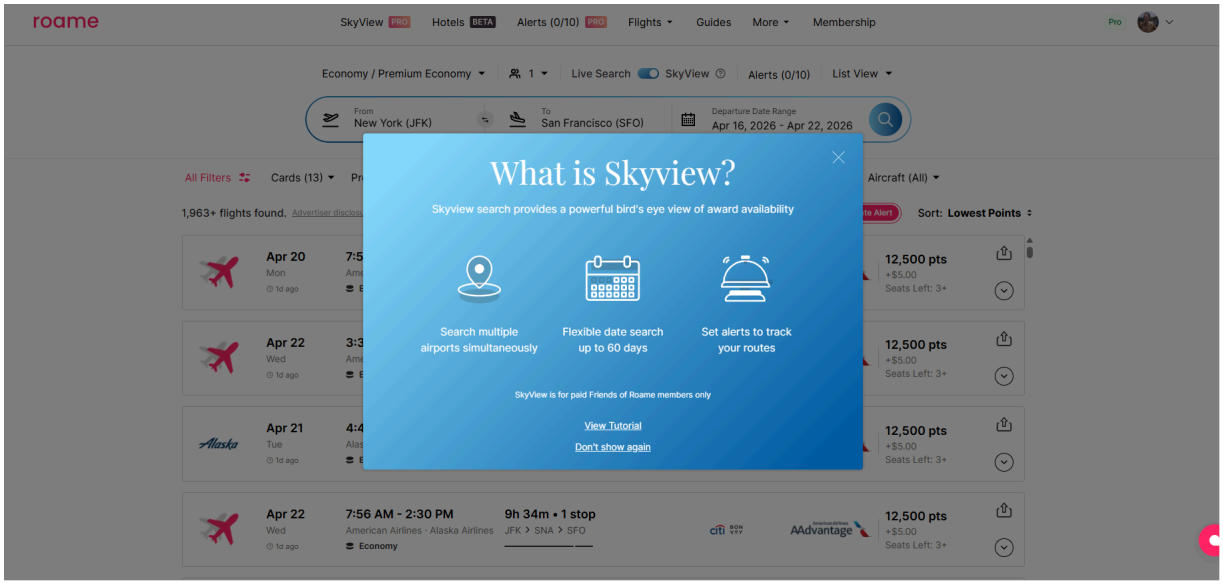
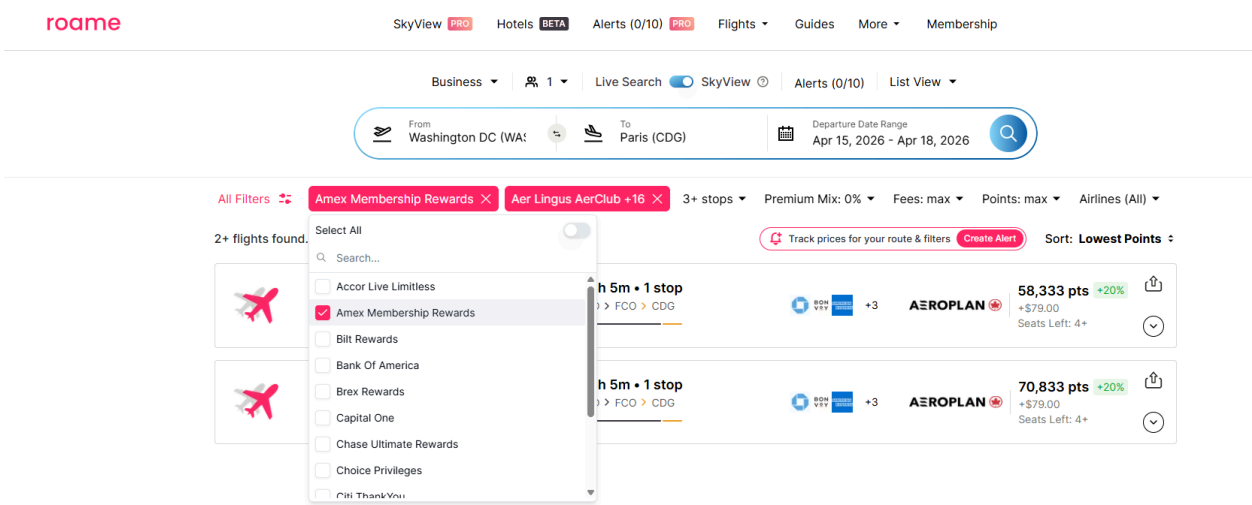
OK, I paid for the premium membership at roame.travel (I have since canceled but I think it's valid through like October since I paid for a year). Skyview allows you to create and save searches that then run every day (?) and send emails when they find results:



Flight search is:

- Origin airport: WAS (searches BWI, DCA and IAD)
- Destination airport is: CDG or FRA or ZRH (going to fly into a separate airport and then take the train to a few cities on our way down to Munich for Oktoberfest)
- ONE WAY FLIGHT (I've heard that it's easier to book via points when you book outbound and return flights separately) (and I don't care as much about business/first class on the flight home)
- Departure date: Sept 15, 16, 17 or 18
- Class: Business Class or First Class
- High preference for a direct flight, but if not, one stop is OK too (but even this will depend on where the stopover is and for how long)

It has a drop down where you indicate what type of points you have, I select "AMEX Membership Rewards"

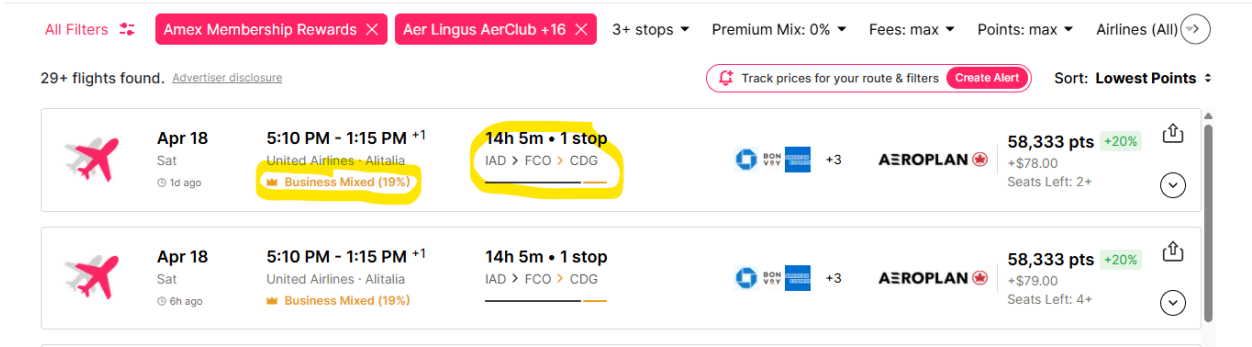


It then auto-selects all of the airlines that you can transfer to from there

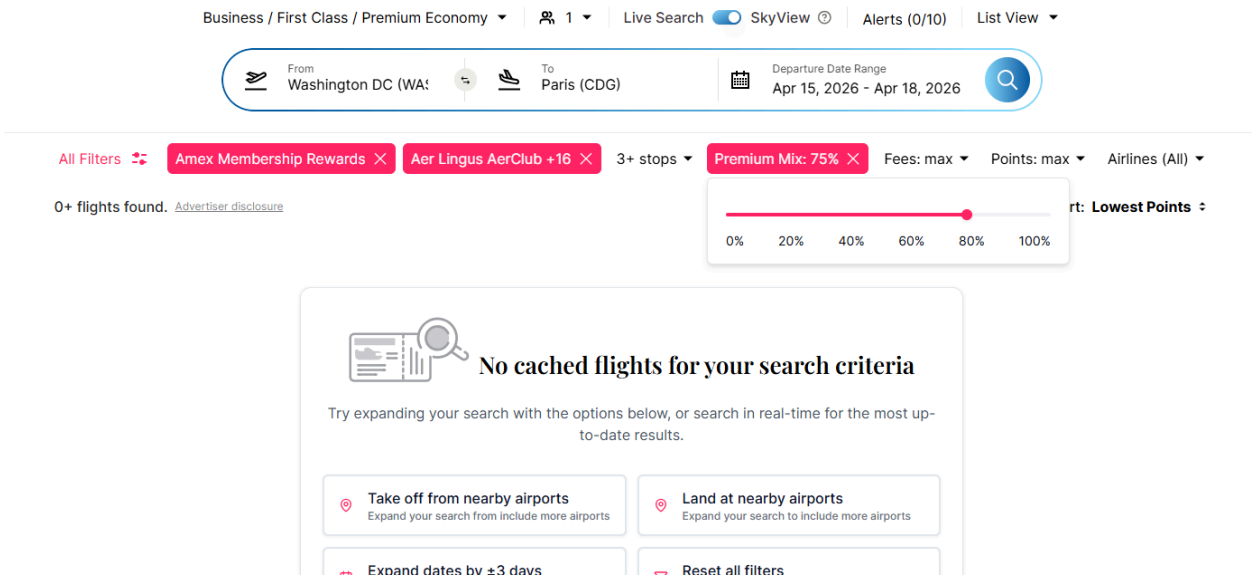
It looks like a good airline to start with would be

- United or AirFrance/KLM for CDG
- Lufthansa/United for FRA
- Swiss/United for ZRH

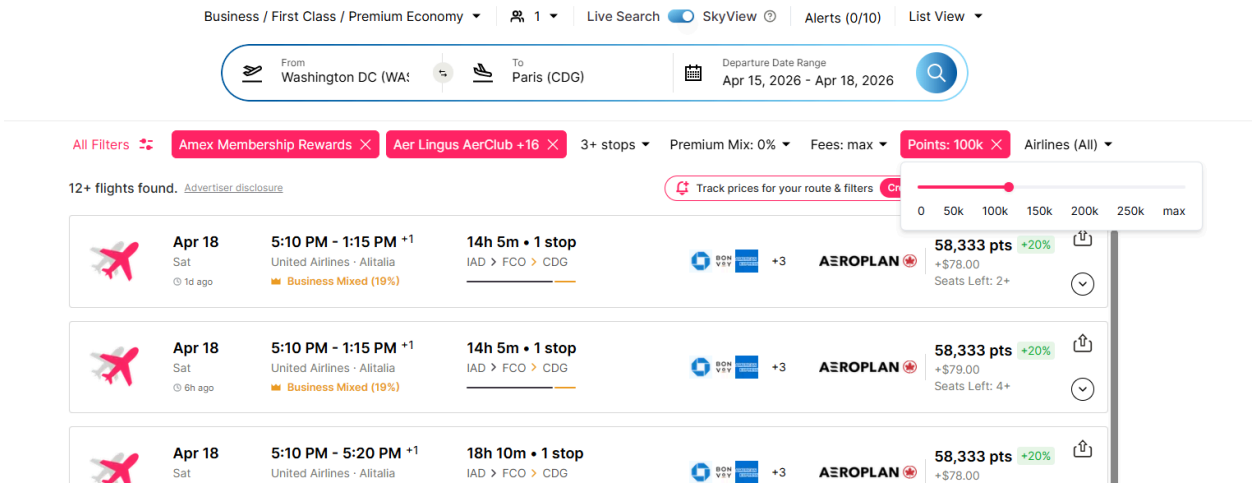
The way that the airlines confuse it is that they present “mixed options” where on a flight with a layover, one of the flights is economy and one of the flights is business or first class. In the example below, the flight from Dulles to Rome (ie the bulk of the travel time) is economy and the short flight from Rome to Paris is business class. You can see it represented in the results in these two ways:



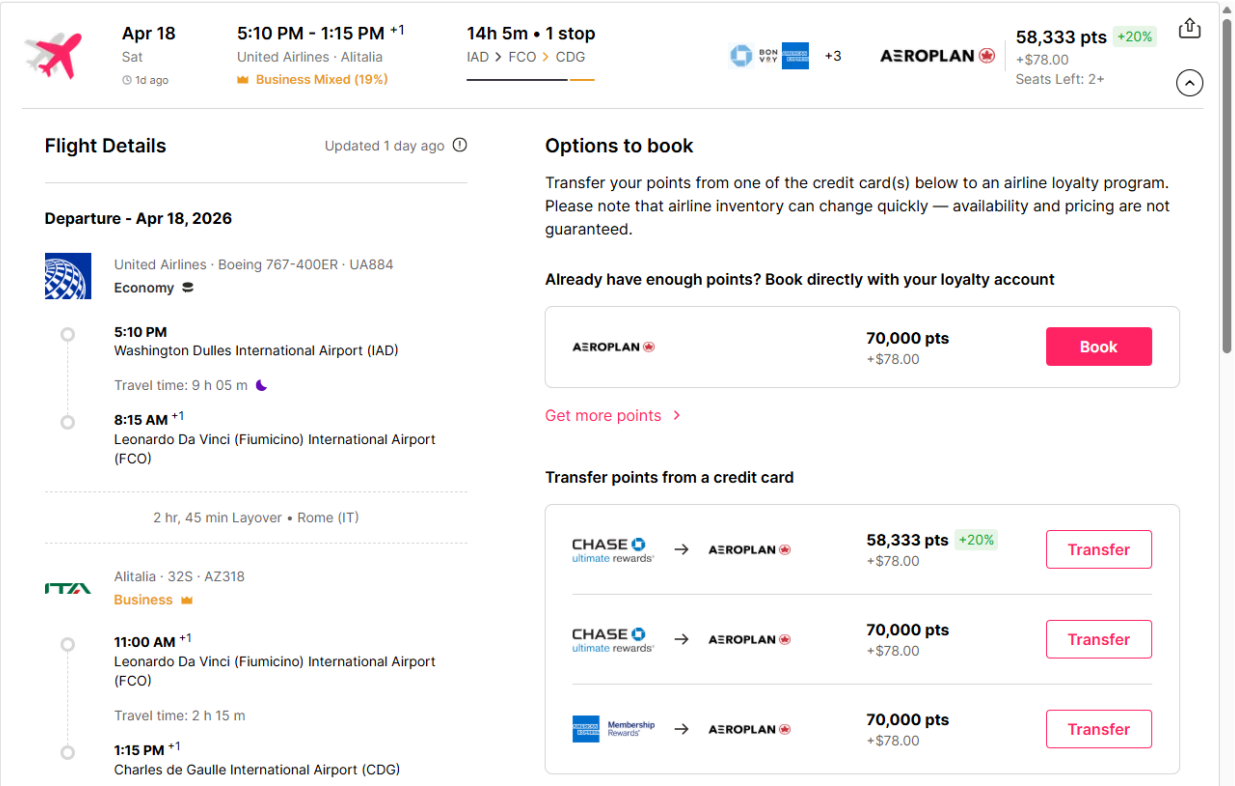
They do have a filter setting where you can set the % of mixed that you’ll allow:



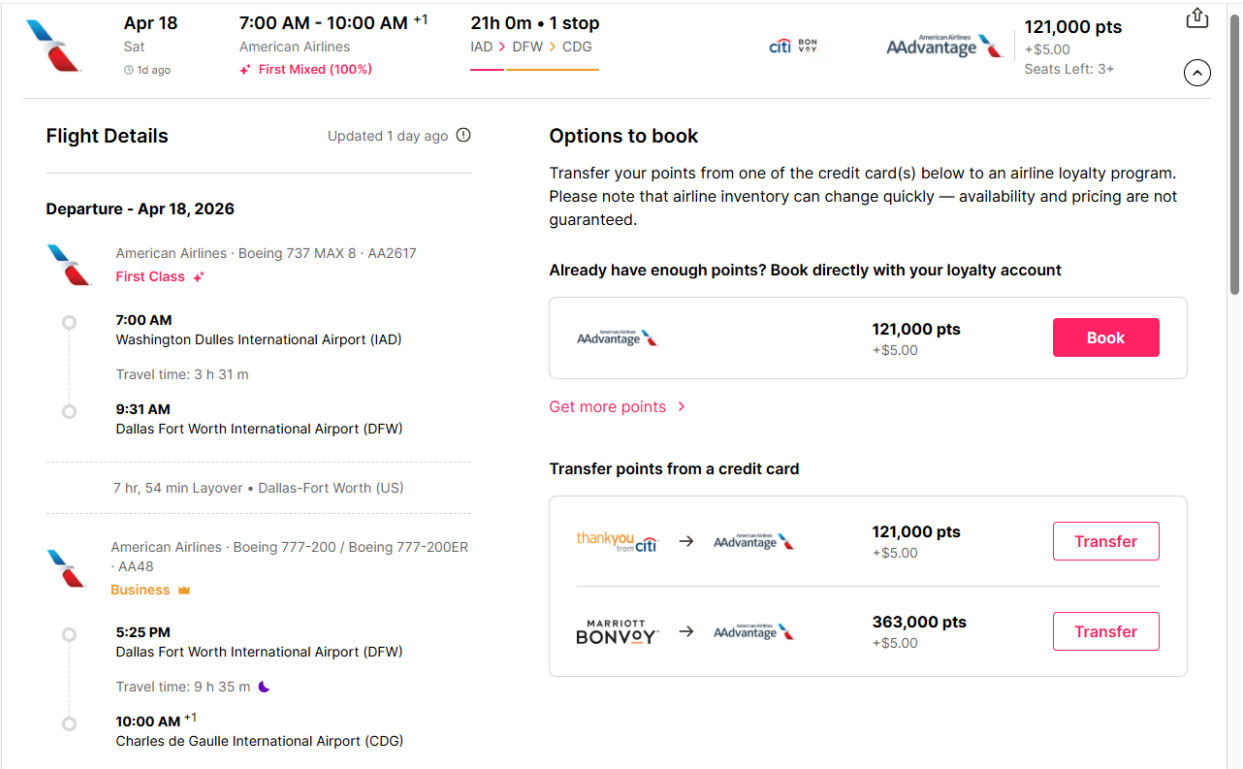
It also lets you set the max points for the flight that you want it to return a result for - I feel like 150k is good:



I like that in the results it shows what the fee cost is. I also like that if you expand open a specific result, it gives you your options for how to transfer:



It’s crazy to see the point transfer difference when you see 120k points from citibank vs 363k points from Marriott! Also, this flight makes zero sense - you fly 3 ½ hours in the wrong direction, then have to spend the night in Dallas, then fly over 9 hours (when it could have been 6 from DC) to Paris.



So I'm feeling like I may have waited too long to be able to actually book a good business or first class flight on points, but I'm happy for you to set up the search for me and see if Claude can find any miracles 🙂

I'm sure you'll have questions as you go through and set it all up - let me know and THANK YOU!!!!!